

## MILESTONES

## VIRAL EXPERT

Conducts virus research at Indiana University in 1950, and gains vital knowledge to aid DNA investigation.

## DNA BREAKTHROUGH

Builds successful model to demonstrate the molecular structure of DNA with Crick in 1953.

## BIOLOGY LECTURER

Is a Senior Research Fellow at Caltech from 1953 to 1955; moves to Harvard in 1956 and teaches biology.

## BIOLOGICAL RESEARCH

Directs the leading center of molecular research in 1968; leads the Human Genome Project in 1989.

US geneticist and biophysicist James Watson launched a new era in biological research with his seminal co-discovery of the double helix structure of DNA, for which he was awarded a Nobel Prize.

James Watson enrolled at the University of Chicago aged 15. He gained a degree in zoology in 1947, then in 1950 completed his PhD in virus research. In 1951, he moved to the Cavendish Laboratory in Cambridge, where he formed a tight and productive partnership with Francis Crick. After publishing their groundbreaking paper on DNA structure, Watson moved to California briefly before returning to the Cavendish to work with Crick on virus construction. He lectured at Harvard, becoming professor of biology in 1960, and published several key biological texts. In 1989, he led the Human Genome Project, an international program that aimed to identify and map all the genes of a human chromosome.

“In science there is only **one answer** and that has to **be correct.**”

James Watson, 1987

**JAMES**

**WATSON**

